

Drying Cannabis in 5 days - (Shark Mouse Farms Method)

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Initial Harvesting

Timing: Harvest the plants during the final hour of their dark cycle to maximize respiration and initiate chlorophyll degradation.

Preparation: Separate branches into individual sections to ensure even diffusion of moisture, hang evenly in the dark.

Phase 1: Initial Drying 48hrs

- Temperature: **72°F (22.2°C)**
- Relative Humidity (RH): **55%**
- Vapor Pressure Deficit (VPD): **1.2 kPa**

Objective:

Begin evaporating surface moisture and pulling internal moisture toward the surface through adhesion.

Phase 2: Drying Trans.. 24hrs

- Increase Temperature: **74°F (23.3°C)**
- Decrease RH: **52%**
- Increase VPD: **1.39 kPa**

Objective:

Increase transpiration rate while maintaining adhesion, pulling internal moisture closer to the surface.

Phase 3: Final Drying 48hrs

- Increase Temperature: **75°F (23.9°C)**
- Decrease RH: **50%**
- Increase VPD: **1.5 kPa**

Objective:

Reduce remaining moisture content in near-surface layers to a final moisture content of 10%.

Preparation for Curing/Storage

After 5 days, the flower comes off the rack, ready to buck, trim, and into jars for curing..

Objective:

Limit degradation of volatile compounds and preserve the overall flavor profile.

Key Principles and Scientific Insights

Low and Slow (60°F/60 RH) Issues

- Surface moisture evaporates quickly, creating a gradient that disrupts internal moisture balance.
- Risk of mold growth due to high internal moisture content (~30%).
- Terpene degradation due to prolonged drying time, despite cooler temperatures.

Thermodynamics and Fick's Law

- Evaporative forces depend on the moisture gradient; high surface evaporation can hinder internal moisture movement.
- Increasing vapor pressure accelerates surface evaporation, which can be controlled by adjusting drying parameters.

Temperature and Time on Terpenes

- Temperature increases can cause gradual terpene loss; however, time has a more significant impact on terpene degradation.
- Shorter drying periods at slightly higher temperatures may better preserve terpenes compared to prolonged drying at lower temperatures.

Chlorophyll Degradation

- Darkness accelerates chlorophyll degradation.
- A controlled environment reduces the "grassy" taste associated with chlorophyll.

